Islamic Aqeedah

العقيدة

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- توحيد الأسماء والصفات

- *This category has five main aspects.*
- *1: Allah must be referred to according to how He and His Prophet have described Him without explaining away His names and attributes by giving them meaning other than their obvious meanings*
- *2: Referring to Allah as He referred to Himself without giving Him any new names or attributes.*

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- *3: Allah is referred to without giving Him the attributes of His creation.*
- *4: Man not to be given the attributes of Allah.*
- *5: Allah's names in the definite form cannot be given to His creation unless preceded by the prefix Abd (Slave of) or servant of.*
- *Many names in indefinite form like Raoof and Raheem are allowable*

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- **توحيد الألوهية (العبادة)**
- *Tawheed al- Ibaadah means that we direct all of our prayers only to Allah, because He is the only one who is able to answer our prayres.*
- *In spite of the wide implications of the first two categories of Tawheed, firm belief in them alone is not sufficient to fulfill the Islamic requirements of Tawheed. Tawheed ar-Ruboobeeyah and Tawheed al-Asmaa was-Sifaat must be accompanied by their complement, Tawheed al-'Ebaadah,*

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- *in order for Tawheed to be considered complete according to Islaam. This point is substantiated by the fact that Allaah Himself has related in clear terms that the Mushrikoon (idolators) of the Prophet's time confirmed many aspects of the first two forms of Tawheed. In the Qur'aan Allaah tells the Prophet (saws) to say to the pagans:*
- *"Say: 'Who is it that gives you all sustenance from the sky and earth, governs sight and hearing, brings forth life from dead (matter) and death from the living, and plans*
- *the affairs of man?' They will all say 'Allaah'.*

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- The pagan Makkans all knew that Allaah was their creator, sustainer, their Lord and Master yet that knowledge did not make them Muslims according to God. In fact, Allaah said: "Most of them do not believe in Allaah except while joining partners to Him

- Some pagan Makkans even believed in the Resurrection and the Judgement and others in predestination (Qadar). Ample evidence of their belief can be found in pre-Islamic poetry. For example,

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- *In spite of the Makkans' confessions of Tawheed and their knowledge of Allaah, Allaah classified*
- *them as disbelievers (Kuffaar) and pagans (Mushrikoon) simply because they worshipped other*
- *gods along with their worship of Allaah.*
- *Consequently, the most important aspect of Tawheed is that of Tawheed al-'Ebaadah, maintaining*
- *the unity of Allaah's worship. All forms of worship must be directed only to Allaah because He*
- *alone deserves worship, and it is He alone who can grant benefit to man as a result of His worship.*

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- *Furthermore, there is no need for any form of intercessor or intermediary between man and God.*
- *Allaah emphasized the importance of directing worship to Him alone by pointing out that this was the main purpose of man's creation and the essence of the message brought by all the prophets.*
- *Allaah says:*
- *"I did not create the Jinn and Mankind except for My worship.""Verily, We have sent to every nation a messenger (saying), 'Worship Allaah and avoid false gods'."*

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- *Understanding the purpose of creation in a complete sense is beyond man's innate abilities. Man is a finite created being and can not reasonably hope to fully comprehend the actions of the infinite Creator. Hence, God made it a part of man's nature to worship Him, and He sent prophets and books of divine revelation to clarify the aspect of the purpose of creation which was within man's mental ability to grasp. That purpose is, as was previously mentioned: the worship of God ('Ebaadah) and the main message of the prophets was to worship God alone,*
- *Tawheed al-'Ebaadah. Consequently, the gravest sin is Shirk, the worship of others instead of Allaah or along with Allaah*

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- *In Soorah al-Faatihah, which every Muslim is required to recite in his or her prayers at least seventeen times daily, verse four reads, "You alone do we worship and from You alone do we seek help". A clear statement that all forms of worship should only be directed to the One who can respond, Allaah. The Prophet Muhammad (saws) confirmed the concept of unity of worship saying, "If you ask in prayer ask only Allaah, and if you seek help, seek it only from Allaah ." The absence of any need for intercession is further emphasized by the many verses indicating His closeness to man.*
- *For example:*

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- *"When My servants ask you (O Muhammad) about Me (tell them), 'Verily I am close*
- *(to them), I listen to the prayer of every one who calls on Me. So let them respond to*
- *Me and believe In Me in order that they may he guided aright.""It is We who created man and We know what his soul whispers to him, for We are nearer to him than his jugular vein."*

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- The confirmation of Tawheed al-'Ebaadah conversely necessitates the denial of all forms of intercession or association of partners with Allaah. If someone prays to the dead seeking their influence on the lives of the living or the souls of those who have passed away, they have associated a partner with Allaah, because worship is being shared between Allaah and His creation. The Prophet Muhammad (saws) said, in no uncertain terms, "Prayer (du'aa) is worship

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- *8 And, Allaah, Most Great and Glorious, said:*
- *'Do not worship besides Allaah that which can not help or harm you.“ "Those on whom you call besides Allaah are only slaves like yourselves."If someone prays to the Prophet (saws), to so-called saints, Jinns or angels asking for help or asking them to request help from Allaah for them, they have also committed Shirk.*
- *The concept of "Ghaus-i-Azam" (al-Ghawth al-A'dHam), a title given by the ignorant to 'Abdul-Qaadir alJeelaanee,51 is also an expression of Shirk in this form of Tawheed.*

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- *The title literally means "the*
- *greatest source of rescue; the one most able to save someone from danger" and such a description*
- *only belongs to Allaah. When misfortune occurs, some people call on 'Abdul-Qaadir by this title*
- *seeking his aid and protection even though Allaah has already said:*
- *"If Allaah allows harm to befall you none can. remove it except Him."*

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- *According to the Qur'aan, when the Makkans were questioned about directing their prayers to their idols, they answered, "We only worship them so that they may bring us closer to Allaah."*
- *The idols were only used as intermediaries yet Allaah called them pagans for their practice. Those among Muslims who insist on praying to other than Allaah would do well to reflect on this fact. Christians, influenced by the teachings of Saul from Tarsus (later called Paul), deified ProphetJesus and directed their prayer to him and his mother. The Catholics among Christians have saints for every occasion to whom they direct their prayers in the belief that these saints can directly influence the affairs of this world*

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- *The Catholics also use their priests as intercessors between themselves and Allaah in the mistaken belief that the priests are closer to Allaah due to their celibacy and piety, and thus more likely to be listened to by Allaah. Most Shi'ite sects have devoted certain days of the week and hours of the day for prayer to 'Alee, Faatimah, Hasan and Husayn due to their distorted belief in intercession.*
- *Worship ('Ebaadah) in the Islamic view, includes more than just fasting, paying Zakaah, Hajj and animal sacrifices. It includes emotions like love, trust, and fear, all of which have degrees which should only be directed to God. Allaah has addressed these emotions and warned against excesses in them as follows:*

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